



San Diego Space Institute
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501(c)(3) Public Charity
sandiegospaceinstitute.org

PRESS RELEASE

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

San Diego Space Institute Recognized by IRS as 501(c)(3) Public Charity

Federal tax-exempt status supports expansion of aerospace education, research, and student spacecraft programs

SAN DIEGO — March 15, 2026 — The San Diego Space Institute (SDSI) announced that it has been recognized by the Internal Revenue Service as a tax-exempt nonprofit organization under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code and classified as a public charity. The determination confirms the organization's eligibility to receive tax-deductible charitable contributions and supports the continued expansion of SDSI programs in aerospace education, technology development, and workforce training.

The IRS determination establishes April 10, 2025, as the effective date of the organization's federal tax-exempt status. Contributions to SDSI are deductible under Section 170 of the Internal Revenue Code, enabling the institute to expand partnerships with universities, industry organizations, and government agencies in support of mission-driven programs.

SDSI serves as a collaborative hub connecting students, universities, industry experts, and government partners to advance space technology development and hands-on engineering education. The institute focuses on interdisciplinary projects that provide students with direct experience in spacecraft systems engineering, mission design, and emerging technologies relevant to both space exploration and terrestrial applications.

One of the organization's flagship initiatives is the **Sentinel-Bio+ CubeSat program**, a

student-driven spacecraft mission focused on monitoring space radiation and hazards affecting human spaceflight. The program is conducted in collaboration with **San José State University** and **San Diego State University** and operates under the **NASA California Space Grant Consortium workforce development program**. Through this initiative, students gain direct experience in spacecraft design, integration, and testing.

“Recognition as a 501(c)(3) public charity strengthens our ability to build partnerships and expand opportunities for students to participate in real space missions,” said Sean Casey, President of the San Diego Space Institute. “Our goal is to create programs where students gain hands-on experience developing spacecraft systems while contributing to research that benefits both space exploration and life on Earth.”

With federal tax-exempt recognition in place, SDSI plans to expand initiatives in areas including spacecraft systems engineering, artificial intelligence, robotics, sensor technologies, additive manufacturing, and space medicine. These programs are designed to support both space exploration and research related to human performance and healthcare in extreme environments.

Organizations, donors, and students interested in supporting SDSI programs can learn more at sandiegospaceinstitute.org.

About the San Diego Space Institute

The San Diego Space Institute (SDSI) is a nonprofit public charity dedicated to advancing aerospace education, space technology development, and workforce training. Through partnerships with universities, industry, and government organizations, SDSI develops student-led spacecraft missions and supports research in aerospace systems, space medicine, and emerging technologies that benefit both space exploration and life on Earth.

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